

Project Title:

ConnectHub – A Student Networking

Developed By:

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Technology Stack:

- **Frontend:** Next.js
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express.js
- **Database:** MongoDB (Atlas)
- **Authentication:** Clerk
- **Media Storage:** Cloudinary

1. Project Purpose

The objective of **ConnectHub** is to create a professional networking platform specifically designed for students. Unlike traditional job-focused platforms, this project serves as a hub for academic and research collaboration, where students can:

- Build academic and skill-based profiles
 - Connect with peers from other institutions
 - Share projects, research papers, and resumes
 - Seek help, guidance, and feedback on academic work
 - Create a community around innovation and learning
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2. Project Objectives

- Facilitate student-to-student networking
 - Enable sharing of academic content like research, papers, and portfolios
 - Offer a user-friendly and secure authentication system
 - Provide cloud-based media management (documents/images)
 - Create a scalable and modular system for future extension (e.g., adding chat, groups, mentorships)
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3. Key Features

- **Authentication with Clerk:** Secure user registration/login
- **Profile Management:** Bio, skills, education, resume upload
- **Post Sharing:** Students can post project updates, images, or document links
- **Project Uploads via Cloudinary:** Upload and manage media (PDFs, images)
- **Explore Section:** View content shared by other students
- **Connections:** Basic follow/connect system

- **Search Functionality:** Search users by name or skill
 - **Responsive UI:** Built with Next.js for performance and cross-device compatibility
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4. Technologies Used

Layer	Technology
Frontend	Next.js
Backend API	Node.js, Express.js
Database	MongoDB Atlas
Authentication	Clerk
Media Hosting	Cloudinary

5. Out of Scope / Limitations

- No support for job postings or company profiles
 - No in-app messaging or chat functionality (future extension)
 - No resume parsing or analytics at this stage
 - User roles limited to “Student” only
 - No real-time notifications implemented
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6. Target Audience

- Undergraduate and postgraduate students
 - Academic project collaborators
 - Research paper authors and teams
 - Students looking to showcase their work to peers and mentors
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7. Deliverables

- Functional full-stack web application
- All associated documents (WBS, Test Plan, RAID Log, etc.)
- Deployment-ready frontend and backend
- GitHub repository with demo video and code
- Scope, Design, and Test documentation